

# Kai Wu

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## EDUCATION

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|---------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>The University of Texas at Austin</b> , Ph.D. in Economics | Aug. 2021 – Present    |
| <b>Jinan University</b> , M.A. in Economics                   | Sept. 2018 – Jun. 2021 |
| <b>Northwest University (China)</b> , B.A. in Economics       | Sept. 2014 – Jun. 2018 |

## RESEARCH FIELDS

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Public Economics, Networks, Environmental Economics, Urban Economics

## REFERENCES

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Marika Cabral</b> (Primary)<br>Department of Economics<br>UT Austin<br><a href="mailto:marika.cabral@utexas.edu">marika.cabral@utexas.edu</a> | <b>Nitya Pandalai-Nayar</b><br>Department of Economics<br>UT Austin<br><a href="mailto:npnayar@utexas.edu">npnayar@utexas.edu</a> | <b>Jackson Dorsey</b><br>Department of Economics<br>UT Austin<br><a href="mailto:jackson.dorsey@austin.utexas.edu">jackson.dorsey@austin.utexas.edu</a> |
| <b>Cody Tuttle</b><br>Department of Economics<br>UT Austin<br><a href="mailto:cody.tuttle@utexas.edu">cody.tuttle@utexas.edu</a>                 | <b>Ben Zou</b><br>Department of Economics<br>Purdue University<br><a href="mailto:zou136@purdue.edu">zou136@purdue.edu</a>        |                                                                                                                                                         |

## WORKING PAPERS

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**Crowding** (with Yizhen Gu, Qu Tang, and Ben Zou) [Job Market Paper]

**Abstract:** Crowding is a common disamenity, yet little is known about its monetary cost. We estimate the willingness to pay (WTP) to avoid crowding in public transit using administrative smartcard trip records from the Beijing Subway and a revealed-preference approach. Passengers choose departure times, trading off fares, in-train crowding, and schedule deviation, with fare variation from an early-bird discount. Leveraging the subway's network structure, we impute real-time in-train crowding, infer each passenger's optimal arrival time, and construct a novel instrumental variable for crowding. The marginal WTP to reduce crowding by one passenger per square meter is about 0.05 RMB per minute, implying a crowding externality comparable to the fare. High-income passengers have higher WTP to avoid crowding but are less price-sensitive. An optimal crowding tax improves welfare within the subway system but is regressive; a two-class configuration elicits self-selection and benefits both high- and low-income commuters.

## Political Consolidation and Corporate Tax Burden

## SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

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**Beyond Targeted Firms: Supply Chain Spillovers of Environmental Regulation in China** (with Xinghua Deng)

This project studies how the costs of environmental regulation propagate along supply chains beyond the targeted firms. Exploiting the 2017 Xiong'an pollution shutdown campaign in China together with ad-

ministrative firm-to-firm transaction data, it examines how the shock transmits to upstream suppliers and downstream customers, and whether losing a trading partner leads firms to contract trade with their remaining partners on both the input and the output side. A general equilibrium production-network model with scale economies links these firm-level responses to the design of environmental policy, comparing emissions taxes with quantity-based regulation.

### **Stock Market Turbulence and Production Networks** (with Husang Kim and Rikuto Onishi)

Research question: Does non-fundamental stock price volatility propagate through production networks?

## **CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS**

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| (* indicates scheduled) UT Austin; ABFER Annual Conference; SEA Annual Meeting*<br>(nominated student) | 2026 |
| Texas Applied Microeconomics Student Workshop                                                          | 2025 |

## **FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS**

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| Summer Excellence Fellowship, Graduate School, The University of Texas at Austin | 2026 |
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## **TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

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*Teaching Assistant, The University of Texas at Austin*

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|------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Introduction to Microeconomics     | 2021, 2022, 2024, 2026 |
| Urban Economics                    | 2022                   |
| Business Strategy                  | 2023                   |
| Industrial Organization            | 2023                   |
| Economics of Education             | 2025                   |
| Energy and Environmental Economics | 2025                   |

## **RESEARCH EXPERIENCE**

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|--------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Research Assistant for Prof. Yizhen Gu     | 2018–2021 |
| Research Assistant for Prof. Marika Cabral | 2023–2025 |

## **SKILLS**

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**Software:** Stata, Python, R, ArcGIS, QGIS, L<sup>A</sup>T<sub>E</sub>X

**Languages:** English (fluent), Chinese (native)